

1. The last six months in LLMs in five minutes

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-19T01:09:44+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/19/5-minute-llms/#atom-everything>

I put together these annotated slides from my five minute lightning talk at PyCon US 2026, using the latest iteration of my annotated presentation tool . # I presented this lightning talk at PyCon US 2026, attempting to summarize the last six months of developments in LLMs in five minutes. # Six months is a pretty convenient time period to cover, because it captures what I've been calling the November 2025 inflection point . November was a critical month in LLMs, especially for coding. # For one thing, the supposedly "best" model (depending mostly on vibes) changed hands five times between the three big providers. # As always, I'm using my Generate an SVG of a pelican riding a bicycle test to help illustrate the differences between the models. Why this test? Because pelicans are hard to draw, bicycles are hard to draw, pelicans can't ride bicycles ... and there's zero chance any AI lab would train a model for such a ridiculous task. # At the start of November the widely acknowledged "best" model was Claude Sonnet 4.5, released on 29th September . It drew me this pelican. In November it was overtaken by GPT-5.1 , then Gemini 3 , then GPT-5.1 Codex Max , and then Anthropic took the...

2. Glaucous-winged Gull, Brown Pelican, Snowy Egret, Canada Goose

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-18T14:51:00+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/18/sighting-362781627/#atom-everything>

Glaucous-winged Gull, Brown Pelican, Snowy Egret, Canada Goose, in Los Angeles River, CA, US
I'm heading home from PyCon US today so I went on a last morning walk to try and spot a pelican. I saw one! Didn't get a great photo of that, but I did see some goslings down by the swan boat lake.

3. Learning on the Shop floor

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-11T15:46:36+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/11/learning-on-the-shop-floor/#atom-everything>

Learning on the Shop floor Tobias Lütke describes Shopify's internal coding agent tool, River, which operates entirely in public on their Slack: River does not respond to direct messages. She politely declines and suggests to create a public channel for you and her to start working in. I myself work with river in #tobi_river channel and many followed this pattern. Every conversation is therefore searchable. Anyone at Shopify can jump in. In my own channel, there are over 100 people who, react to threads, add color and add context, pick up the torch, help with the reviews, remind me how rusty I am, and importantly, learn from watching. [...] As so often with German, there is a word for the kind of environment: Lehrwerkstatt . Literally: A teaching workshop . The whole shop floor is the classroom. You learn by being near the work. Being a constant learner is one of the core values of the firm. Shopify wants to be a Lehrwerkstatt at scale and River has now gotten us closer to this ideal than ever. It's osmosis learning , because it does not require a curriculum, a training plan, or a manager. It just requires everyone's work to be visible to the maximum extent possible. Everyone learn...

4. How I Use My Index 01 + Production Update

Source: Eric Migicovsky's Blog RSS Feed | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://repebble.com/blog/how-i-use-my-index-01-production-update>

TL;DR Production Update - behind schedule but on track How I use my Index 01 - watch the video for demos! Product design philosophy - why?

5. [Sponsor] WorkOS: Agents Need Context. Ship the Integrations That Give It to Them.

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-19T01:27:00Z

Link: https://workos.com/docs/pipes?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q22026

The context that actually matters isn't in your database. It's in the tools your users live in every day. Multi-stage agents stall the moment they hit a step they can't see. And every missing integration is a different OAuth flow, a different token lifecycle, weeks of plumbing before the agent reads a single record. WorkOS Pipes connects your agent to the tools your users live in. Pre-built connectors for GitHub, Slack, Salesforce, Google Drive, and more. Pipes handles OAuth, token refresh, and credential storage. You call the real provider API with a fresh token, every time. Your agent pulls context at every step, for as long as the task runs. Give your agent context ? ?

6. Jury Rejects Elon Musk's Claim Against Sam Altman in Unanimous Verdict

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-18T17:53:33Z

Link: https://www.nytimes.com/live/2026/05/18/technology/openai-trial-verdict-altman-musk?unlocked_article_code=1.jVA.Cc2V.lwYuu2r4SJfQ

Cade Metz and Mike Isaac, reporting for The New York Times (gift link): A nine-person jury found that Elon Musk did not bring his lawsuit against OpenAI and Sam Altman until after the expiration of the three-year statute of limitations. Mr. Musk filed his suit against the \$730 billion artificial intelligence start-up in the summer of 2024, but the jury found that he was aware of the behavior discussed in his complaint against OpenAI as far back as 2021. This update quoting Judge Yvonne Gonzalez Rogers's "poetic" jury instructions is just lovely: "A jury reflects the attitudes and mores of the community from which it is drawn," she said, paraphrasing another judge. "It lives only for the day and does justice according to its limits. The group of jurors who are drawn to hear a case make a decision and then melt away. It is not present the next day to be criticized. It is the one governmental agency that has no ambition. It is as human as the people who make it up." ?

7. "John Appleseed"

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-18T17:34:46Z

Link: <https://om.co/2026/04/20/john-appleseed/>

Here's a great take from last month re: the Cook/Ternus transition, from Om Malik: When he took over from Steve Jobs in August 2011, Apple's market capitalization was around \$350 billion. As of this morning, it sits near \$4 trillion. That is more than a 1,000 percent increase. Revenue went from \$108 billion in fiscal 2011 to over \$416 billion in fiscal 2025, almost four times bigger. Apple under Cook became the most valuable company in human history, multiple times over. It built Services into a \$100-billion-a-year business. Sure, Cook inherited the greatest product portfolio and the greatest brand in modern business. How many times have we seen people screw it up? He ran it with operational ruthlessness. He is no product visionary, and neither is Ternus. They are not Steve. Tim has run Apple for fifteen years, through a pandemic, two trade wars, a supply chain reordering, and the slow grinding shift from hardware-only to hardware-plus-services-plus-silicon. Most importantly, he didn't mess it up. Services, as a whole, is now as big a business for Apple as the entirety of the company was when Cook took the helm. And "not screwing it up" is an enormous accomplishment. Success is al...

8. CISA Admin Leaked AWS GovCloud Keys on Github

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 20:48:21 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/05/cisa-admin-leaked-aws-govcloud-keys-on-github/>

Until this past weekend, a contractor for the Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) maintained a public GitHub repository that exposed credentials to several highly privileged AWS GovCloud accounts and a large number of internal CISA systems. Security experts said the public archive included files detailing how CISA builds, tests and deploys software internally, and that it represents one of the most egregious government data leaks in recent history.

9. The just-say-no engineer was a ZIRP phenomenon

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/the-just-say-no-engineer-was-a-zirp-phenomenon/>

The engineer who says no all the time is a real archetype among senior and staff engineers. Their role is to slow things down, to block the development of features that add complexity, and to ensure that as little code gets written as possible (since code is a liability). We can think of this as the just-say-no engineer 1, as opposed to the just-say-yes engineer. The just-say-yes engineer is obsessed with moving fast, approves code changes by default, values MTTR over MTBF, and tends to ship a lot of code. The just-say-no engineer is obsessed with quality, is happy to move slowly, and blocks code changes by default. Most engineers are somewhere in the middle of the spectrum. By 'just-say-no engineer', I'm talking about the group of engineers who most strongly identify with that archetype. The just-say-no engineer is having a hard time in the era of AI. It used to be that they only had to say no to more junior engineers' handwritten PRs, but now they have to say no to a barrage of AI-generated code, some of it generated by managers and VPs who are politically difficult to say no to. For the first time in their careers, they're under a lot of pressure to lower their standards and...

10. Don't call yourself a Software Engineer, you are an AI Enabled Engineer.

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 12:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/you-are-an-ai-enabled-engineer-now?src=feed>

I can only imagine what it's like learning the skill of programming in this day and age. What does an average college class look like? What is the CS professor teaching? And students, how do you reconcile what you are learning vs the current job market? I know if I was a student today, I would at least attempt to make connections on LinkedIn to prepare for a future where I would need those connections to get a job. But LinkedIn is not a real place. It might have been at one point. But it certainly isn't today. Everybody is an AI Engineer/Leverager/Prompter/Professional. If I wasn't in the industry, it would be real confusing. I see my ex-colleagues right there on LinkedIn, gainfully employed, yet still felt the need to update their titles. We've worked together, I know their current role. Or at least I thought I knew. Now, that same role leverages AI in a way that has "enabled" them. The software engineers though, their role has remained the same while the entire marketing department has switched to AI first. The software engineer is being left behind. The whole company is moving fast, yet the person writing the code using Claude, Cursor, Codex, Copilot, that person remains a me...

11. Always Be Blaming

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-05-18T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/05/18/always-be-blaming.html>

A few tips on 4D-ing your code comprehension skills.

12. Unicode and Emoji in terminals, or my simple but difficult wish

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-18T03:13:25Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/tech/UnicodeEmojiInTerminals>

On the Fediverse, I had a simple sounding wish: This is my face that I need a simple pagination program for Unix (show a page, pause, hit CR to show the next page) that is Unicode and emoji aware, so that it knows how long lines with them are. AFAIK less can't be used for this when I don't want it to ever clear the screen, just to keep printing the next page for however long. (... because you have to know how long lines of text are so that you know when you've printed a full page.) (So what I'd like is 'cat, but paginated'.) This sounds like a simple, easy wish. Some of my readers are now laughing flatly, because it's not. In fact I believe it's impossible to write a simple general program to do this; you need either terminal program specific knowledge or to do some relatively extreme tricks as you print text. Once upon a time, physical terminals and thus terminal programs were simple. They showed a set of characters in a monospaced grid, commonly with bytes mapping one to one to displayed characters (I'm ignoring DEC's double-sized character escape sequences). In this world, 'cat but paginated' is relatively simple, and indeed I have a program that does exactly this job; the onl...

13. Human Bottlenecks

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/human-bottlenecks>

Why AI won't augment human capabilities much.

14. Something's Rotten in the State of macOS Icon Design

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/rotten-macos-icon-design/>

This is an iconic observation : If you put the Apple icons in reverse it looks like the portfolio of someone getting really really good at icon design This isn't, however, just the story of Apple's Creator Studio icons. It's the unfolding story of icon design across the entire macOS platform. For example, take a look at some of Apple's other apps like iMovie : Or Remote Desktop : Apple sets the standard (and the rules) for how icons look on the Mac. Wherever they go, so goes the ecosystem ? and they're taking the entire ecosystem along down with them. It's fast becoming the case that if you put any Mac app's icons in reverse, it looks like the portfolio of someone getting really, really good at icon design. Even Microsoft ? not exactly a bastion of design ? starts to look pretty decent with their icons the further back you go. For example, with OneNote , the app icon's progression looks like it went something like this: ?I made this with AI? ?I tried to make the AI one, but by hand myself? ?I don't need to be constrained by this squircle? ?Hey, I'm getting better at this? Some 3rd-party apps continue to fight a good fight, even as Apple's definition of what an icon should be ? or...

15. 10Gb/s Ethernet: using mini-heatsinks with a 10GBASE-T SFP+ module

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 19:15:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilesthomas.com/2026/05/10g-ethernet-sfpplus-mini-heatsinks>

In my last post I showed the somewhat-scary temperatures I was getting on the MikroTik 10GBASE-T SFP+ module I have plugged into nigel , the 10Gb/s switch I have in my study. As I mentioned then, the plan was to try using some of the mini-heatsinks that people use on Raspberry Pis, to see if that would help. Here's how it went. I bought a 40-piece set of heatsinks made by the improbably-named VooGenzek on Amazon for ?8 , and attached two of them like this -- see the bottom module, with the yellow cable: That was 24 hours ago, and here's a chart of temperatures from that module showing the 24 hours before and after: You can see the big drop-off in the middle of the chart; it even overshot a bit (I'm guessing because the heatsinks absorbed a bunch of heat initially when I put them on). The difference looks more dramatic than it is! See where the Y-axis starts. But given that the weather has been pretty much the same today as it was yesterday, that looks like a 3.5°C improvement. Not great, but not nothing either. In the copious discussion about the last post on Hacker News , one of the most popular comments -- from xxpor -- was that there are two generations of SFP+ modules for this...

16. Travel notes: RubyKaigi Hakodate

Source: Max Bernstein's Blog | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: https://bernsteinbear.com/blog/travel-notes-rubykaigi-hakodate/?utm_source=rss

I just got back from a three and a half week trip to Japan. It was the longest trip I have ever been on (aside from studying abroad in Germany, which felt different). I made the following wild circuit with only a backpack and a duffel: Tokyo Toyama Kanazawa Nara ish Ito Hakodate Nikko Mashiko Karuizawa Tokyo This trip was split into three parts: time with my immediate family, going to a conference, and then time with my partner. They were all great and also I am glad to be home. I'll post my abbreviated travel notes here, including activity and food recommendations. Part one We started in Tokyo but we were only there for about 40 hours. We focused our time mostly on arts and crafts: we did a kintsugi workshop, spent time at an artists cooperative, and then did a lot of walking around. This was a good intro to the trip, because everyone kept waking up at 4am and crashing at 7pm due to the jet lag. 4am wakeup makes for nice morning walks to 7-Eleven. I brought my family to T's Tantan in Tokyo Station because I'm vegetarian and it's otherwise hard to find ramen that approaches kosher in Japan. It

continues to be great and I really appreciate having a steady vegetarian option availabl...

17. Weekly Update 504

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 03:46:55 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-504/>

It's a hot topic, the old "pay or don't pay" for hackers not to leak your data. Since recording this a few days ago, we've had Grafana go with the "no pay" approach , and I've seen a raft

18. FediMeteo, HAProxy, and the art of not wasting snac threads

Source: IT Notes | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 09:44:00 +0000

Link: <https://it-notes.dragas.net/2026/05/18/fedimeteo-haproxy-and-the-art-of-not-wasting-snac-threads/>

When I wrote about FediMeteo for the first time, I told the story from the beginning: the idea born almost by chance while checking the weather for a holiday, the memory of my grandfather, who for years had been my personal meteorologist, the decision to build something small and useful, and then the surprise of seeing people actually use it. What began as a personal experiment quickly became a small global service, still running with the same philosophy: FreeBSD, jails, simple scripts, snac, text, emoji, and a lot of small pieces doing their work quietly. That article was mostly about the birth and growth of the project. This one is about one of the less romantic parts of the same story, although I have to admit that I find a certain beauty in it too: keeping the service light as it grows. FediMeteo is still intentionally simple from the outside. A homepage, some numbers, a list of countries, and many ActivityPub accounts publishing weather forecasts. The posts are text and emoji. There is no JavaScript requirement to read the pages, no heavy frontend, no unnecessary media attached to every forecast, and no dynamic homepage recalculated at every visit just to show the same number...

19. Vitamin D: the New COVID-19 Chloroquine?

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 30 May 2020 17:52:44 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/vitamin-d-the-new-covid-19-chloroquine/>

Welcome to this post, in which we'll be taking a trip through the wild and bumpy ride that has been Vitamin D & sunlight research over the past few decades, and what it might mean for COVID-19. As with my previous post, before any non-specialist attempts to write something on COVID-19, we should wonder: are any actual experts already writing on this, and if not, why not. Enough badly informed stuff has already been published by amateurs that before posting we should be certain we are actually being helpful.

20. COVID-19 Predictions & Rampant Speculation: May 2020

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 24 May 2020 10:49:02 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/covid-19-rampant-speculation-may-2020/>

It turns out that so far, I have written over 44000 words on COVID-19. I've tried very hard to only report the best and most trustworthy science, but I did strive to include interesting new insights that were not yet mainstream. As an example, I spoke about vitamin D and sunlight real early, which now indeed appears to be a thing. No guarantees yet, but it definitely is a thing.

21. How COVID-19 is diagnosed: bacterium assisted DNA searching

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 22 May 2020 17:18:33 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/dna-grep-2019-ncov/>

This post is dedicated to lab technicians everywhere doing the difficult work institutes and hospitals rely on to investigate disease and keep us healthy. Lab work requires high precision, deep understanding, is physically demanding, and can even be dangerous. Although our healthcare systems & universities would come to a grinding halt without lab technicians, they are often almost literally invisible somewhere far away. Thank you all for your hard work!